

PRINCIPLES THAT LEAD TO SUCCESS

Blue denotes power point slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

TEXT: 1 Chronicles 12:18 (KJV) *"Then the spirit came upon Amasai, who was chief of the captains, and he said, Thine are we, David, and on thy side, thou son of Jesse: peace, peace be unto thee, and peace be to thine helpers; for thy God helpeth thee. Then David received them, and made them captains of the band."*

INTRO: If there is a predominant sin of the age that we live in, I would think it must be the sin of half heartedness. There is a real deficiency of commitment to God or anything else for that matter. **In this culture many are no longer committed to: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Family...
- Marriage...
- Profession...
- Institutions...

(Story of the chicken, pig, and the mission's breakfast. The chicken only had to be involved; the pig had to be committed.)

I am convinced that it is the will of God for us to be committed to the purposes of God and to have victory in every situation! The Christian life should be a journey

"From faith to faith, and victory to victory."

If we are planning to be victorious we must make up our minds that no matter what happens, we will not give up, or be sidetracked!

In this chapter David is brought before us as a type of Christ. David was God's appointed and anointed king, but initially only a few accepted him as such. The majority gave their allegiance to Saul, whom God had rejected! They thought they were on the winning team, when in reality they were on a team doomed to failure. No matter how lopsided the odds may be in our favor or in opposition to us, if God is not in the mix, success will be an elusive commodity.

There are many people in this world who would give their right arm to control everything which affects their lives but I want to declare today that Jesus Christ is the rightful King; God has appointed and anointed him! **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)** [Philippians 2:9,10](#) (KJV) *"Wherefore God also hath highly exalted him and given him a name which is above every name: That at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, of things in heaven, and things in earth, and things under the earth;"* [Ephesians 1:20](#) (KJV) *".. God raised Jesus from the dead and set him at his own right hand in heavenly places..."* [Ephesians 2:6](#) (KJV) *"God has raised us up with Christ and has made us to sit together in heavenly places."*

In our text David had been rejected, and during his rejection, David needed people who not only admired him at a distance and believed in him secretly, but people who would come out boldly and follow him. As a pastor I have been there when people said *"All we*

need is someone to stand up ..." When you do, you are often the only one who is! People will say "*We are behind you brother...*" They are so far behind you; they are only a faint speck in the rear view mirror! (Story of the guy on a bicycle who pulled up beside the corvette at the stoplight and was admiring such a sleek driving machine...)

Pastors and church leaders greatly appreciate those who will stand with them in difficult times! The reward of such people will be great in Heaven. *The loyal support of Gods people for His leaders does not escape the attention of eternal reward.*

David needed people who would not turn their backs on the day of battle! This is exactly what our King is looking for today, people with a made up mind who will stand boldly against the enemy and the tide of darkness, and be counted in the army of God!

Young people, whether you are going to be a business man or woman, a pastor, missionary, deacon, youth pastor, butler, baker, candlestick maker, or whatever, stand up for Jesus! Song: "*I'll stand for Jesus and let the world go by...*"

I think we can take a lesson from the kind of people who supported David in this difficult time! There is without question a direct corolation between David's men and us with regard to what it takes to be effective and successful. Let's take a look at the *requirements for being successful over the long haul:* **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Total commitment
- Thorough training
- Cost counting
- Supernatural strength
- Unquestioned loyalty

I. TOTAL COMMITMENT

1 Chronicles 12:8 (KJV) "*And of the Gadites there separated themselves unto David into the hold to the wilderness....*" Please remember, when these people made the decision to support David and his effort, they could never retreat! Retreat would not be tolerated; in fact, to do so would almost certainly be a signature on their death warrant! This decision was a total commitment to David and his cause!

The same thing happens to you and I; **Christ followers have no real place of retreat!** Proverbs 13:15 (KJV) "*Good understanding giveth favour: but the way of transgressors is hard.*" If one is going to live a victorious life the best thing that we can do is to burn the bridges of retreat behind us!

ILLUSTRATION: When Cortez landed at Vera Cruz in 1519 to begin his conquest of Mexico, he had a small band of soldiers, which consisted of about 700 men. Once he landed it is said that he purposely set fire to his small fleet of 11 ships. His small army watched as their only means of retreat sank to the bottom of the Gulf of Mexico. With the only means of retreat destroyed, the only way to move was forward, into the Mexican interior to meet whatever might come their way!

So it is with being a soldier in the army of God! If one is to be effective in the Christian walk a total commitment to Christ and His cause must be made in advance! 2 Timothy 2:4 (KJV) *"No man that warreth entangleth himself with the affairs of this life; that he may please him who hath chosen him to be a soldier."* Hebrews 13:12-14 (KJV) *"Wherefore Jesus also, that he might sanctify the people with his own blood, suffered without the gate. (13) Let us go forth therefore unto him without the camp, bearing his reproach. (14) *For here have we no continuing city, but we seek one to come."**

We live in perilous times, and it is sad when those who are supposed to be Soldiers in the army of God side with those who have rejected Christ as king! It is most difficult in these times to ascertain the difference between the world and the church on many fronts:
(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Political issues...
- Character issues...
- Lifestyle issues...
- Doctrinal issues...

As you read this chapter you will soon find out that David required men of quality, selected, separated men! Men who had made an all-out commitment to his cause and vision, men who would get the job done no matter the difficulty! Are we ready to stand up to the world and sell out to Jesus and His cause?

Are we totally committed to Christ to the point that we

have already determined that nothing can separate us
from Him or His cause? WHO CAN SEPARATE US
FROM THE LOVE OF CHRIST?

II. THOROUGH TRAINING

Notice 1 Chronicles 12:2, 8, & 38 (KJV) *“They were armed with bows and could use both the right hand and the left in hurling stones and shooting arrows out of a bow, even of Saul's brethren of Benjamin. (8) And of the Gadites there separated themselves unto David into the hold to the wilderness men of might, and men of war fit for the battle, that could handle shield and buckler, whose faces were like the faces of lions, and were as swift as roes upon the mountains; (38) All these men of war, that could keep rank, came with a perfect heart to Hebron, to make David king over all Israel: and all the rest also of Israel were of one heart to make David king.”*

The men who chose to support David were not sissies, they were lean, mean, fighting machines who had their mind made up that this was a cause worth dying for! Just because they had their mind made up and were committed to the cause did not mean that they would never need to fight.

How foolish to believe that Christian life will be easy street! If we are going to be effective soldiers we must

make up our minds that this is a cause worth dying for. If this is such a worthy cause we should do everything in our power to become trained, disciplined, and properly equipped.

We have been given the whole armor of God for a reason, to fight the enemy! [Ephesians 6:10-18](#) (KJV) *"Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord, and in the power of his might (11) Put on the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil (12) For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against spiritual wickedness in high places. (13) Wherefore take unto you the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand. (14) Stand therefore, having your loins girt about with truth, and having on the breastplate of righteousness; (15) And your feet shod with the preparation of the gospel of peace; (16) Above all, taking the shield of faith, wherewith ye shall be able to quench all the fiery darts of the wicked. (17) And take the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God: (18) Praying always with all prayer and supplication in the Spirit, and watching thereunto with all perseverance and supplication for all saints;"*

If we are going to fight this good fight of faith, we must put our armor on and make up our minds that we will fight to the finish! If we move forward with this mind set and armor we can make it! [2 Corinthians 10:3-6](#) (KJV) *"For though we walk in the flesh, we*

do not war after the flesh: (4) For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but mighty through God to the pulling down of strong holds; (5) Casting down imaginations, and every high thing that exalteth itself against the knowledge of God, and bringing into captivity every thought to the obedience of Christ; (6) And having in a readiness to revenge all disobedience, when your obedience is fulfilled"

III. COST COUNTING

The warfare David's men were engaged in could prove to be very costly, but they had decided that this was a cause worth dying for! [1 Chronicles 12:15](#) (KJV)

"These are they that went over Jordan in the first month, when it had overflowed all its banks: and they put to flight all them of the valleys, both toward the east, and toward the west." These were men of grit, gall, and backbone, crossing a river at flood-stage to fight a battle that could mean their life!

[What kind of hardship are we willing to endure in order to win this good fight of faith?](#) If we hope to be victorious, we must have our mind made up to persevere despite the odds.

ILLUSTRATION: When James Calvert went out as a Missionary to the cannibals of the Fiji Islands, the captain of the ship sought to turn him back. *"You will lose your life and the lives of those with you if you go among such savages,"* he said. Calvert only replied, *"We died before we came..."* God give us some more James Calvert's!

Have we...

- Counted the cost of friendships?
- Counted the cost of material possessions?
- Counted the cost of worldly popularity?
- Counted the cost of surrender?
- Counted the cost of submission to authority?

The cost of selling out to Jesus in pursuit of the victorious life can be very high, but the juice is worth the squeeze! Are we willing to pay the price of victory?

IV. SUPERNATURAL STRENGTH

1 Chronicles 12:8 (KJV) *"And of the Gadites there separated themselves unto David into the hold to the wilderness men of might, and men of war, fit for the battle, that could handle shield and buckler, whose faces were like the faces of lions, and were as swift as the roes upon the mountains;"(21) And they helped David against the band of the rovers: for they were all mighty men of valor, and were captains in the host."*

These men were:

1. Men of strength... *"Men of might..."*
2. Men who were experienced fighters... *"Men of war..."*
3. Men who were battle ready... *"Fit for battle..."*
4. Men who knew how to get the most out of their weapons... *"Handle shield and buckler..."*
5. Men in whose faces only courage could be seen... *"Faces were like the faces of lions..."*
6. Men who were sure-footed in the day of

battle... *“Swift as roes (goats) upon the mountains...”*

7. Men who were full of faith rather than fear...
“Mighty men of valor....”
8. Men whose leadership skills had been tested and proven... *“Captains in the host...”*

The men who were following David were probably not physical specimens of strength and power but they had their minds made up to stay the course and support what they believed to be right. They were men whose total reliance was upon God.

Let me remind you that none of us win the victory in and of ourselves! We must have supernatural strength and anointing! When we walk in the anointing, 300 men with pitchers and lanterns can defeat every imp in hell, or Houston!

- The anointing will provide an ark for the floodwaters...
- The anointing will rob the heat from our fiery furnaces...
- The anointing will give the lions lockjaw when we are called upon to spend a night in their den...
- The anointing will cause us to come back from the battle dragging a bloody giants head...
- The anointing will neutralize the venom of a deadly viper...
- The anointing will cause the improbable to become probable...
- The anointing will cause the impossible to

become possible...

Leviticus 26:7-9 (KJV) *"And ye shall chase your enemies, and they shall fall before you by the sword. (8) And five of you shall chase an hundred, and an hundred of you shall put ten thousand to flight: and your enemies shall fall before you by the sword. (9) For I will have respect unto you, and make you fruitful, and multiply you, and establish my covenant with you."* This is not possible without two things:
The anointing...
A made up mind...

V. UNQUESTIONED LOYALTY

1 Chronicles 12:16-18 (KJV) *"And there came of the children of Benjamin and Judah to the hold unto David. (17) And David went out to meet them, and answered and said unto them, if ye become peaceably unto me to help me, mine heart shall be knit unto you: but if ye be come to betray me to mine enemies, seeing there is no wrong in mine hands, the God of our fathers look thereon, and rebuke it. (18) Then the spirit came upon Amasai, who was chief of the captains, and he said, Thine are we, David, and on thy side, thou son of Jesse: peace, peace be unto thee, and peace be to thine helpers; for thy God helpeth thee. Then David received them, and made them captains of the band,"* David could sense the loyalty of these gutsy, hearty followers. He could sense that these were people who would have his back on the day of battle. They were people who would not cause worry lines in his forehead!

If we are going to live a victorious life we must be people of unquestioned loyalty!

The harder the battle, the more necessary the commitment to loyalty becomes! [Mark 8:34](#) (KJV)

"And when he had called the people unto him with his disciples also, he said unto them, Whosoever will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me." According to Jesus, three things are required to become one of His disciples:

- Self-denial...
- Cross-bearing...
- Follow-ship...

SONG: *"I have decided to follow Jesus." "Where He leads me I will follow."*